MEDORBITS • CAREER RESOURCES

COVER LETTER WRITING GUIDE

Connect your experience to the employer's needs

Practical guidance • Clear steps • Honest representation

A practical framework for writing a focused cover letter. Follow the employer's instructions; a cover letter is not required for every application.

1. Understand the role

- Identify the employer's stated needs and the role's most important responsibilities.
- Choose two or three relevant examples that support your fit.
- Use a specific recipient or role title when known; avoid guessing personal details.

2. Structure the letter

- Opening: identify the role and briefly state your relevant interest.
- Middle: connect evidence from your experience, studies or projects to the role's needs.
- Closing: express interest in discussing your application and thank the reader.

3. Keep the evidence specific

- Explain why a relevant example matters for this role.
- Avoid copying the resume word for word; add context rather than repeating every bullet.
- Do not claim knowledge of the employer or its culture that you cannot support.

4. Keep it professional

- Use clear paragraphs, a suitable greeting and a concise close.
- Follow any length, format or upload instructions provided by the employer.
- Proofread the employer name, job title, contact details and attachment.

5. Final review

- Ensure the letter is tailored, truthful and consistent with your resume.
- Remove placeholders and template instructions before submitting.
- Save a copy of the submitted version with the application record.

Key takeaways

- Write for one role at a time.
- Use examples rather than unsupported adjectives.
- Follow the employer's requested format and length.

Important: This is general career-development information, not a guarantee of employment or a substitute for employer-specific instructions or qualified legal advice. Verify role-specific and location-specific requirements independently.

MedOrbits • Career resource. Review the employer's instructions and adapt this material to your circumstances.